

Leave Policy and Leave Benefits

A well-defined leave policy is essential for ensuring employee well-being, maintaining work-life balance, and promoting a healthy and productive work environment. The organization provides a comprehensive range of paid, statutory, and special leave benefits that support employees during personal, professional, educational, and family-related situations. These leave provisions not only comply with organizational and government regulations but also reflect the company's commitment to employee welfare. The leave system is designed to accommodate the diverse needs of employees working in both onshore offices and offshore operational locations, ensuring fairness, flexibility, and operational continuity.

1. Standard Paid Leaves

Standard paid leaves are provided to all eligible employees to help them manage planned vacations, personal commitments, emergencies, and health-related issues without affecting their financial stability. These leaves are granted annually and are governed by specific eligibility criteria and accumulation rules.

Earned Leave (EL)

Earned Leave (EL), also referred to as Privilege Leave, is one of the most valuable components of the leave policy. Employees earn approximately **30 to 32 days of Earned Leave every year**, depending on the applicable service rules and organizational guidelines. These leaves are accumulated over the course of service and are intended primarily for planned vacations, family functions, personal commitments, long breaks, or any extended period of absence from work.

One of the major advantages of Earned Leave is that it **can be accumulated over multiple years**. Employees who do not utilize their full annual entitlement are allowed to carry forward the remaining leave balance. The maximum accumulation permitted is **up to 280 days**, enabling employees to preserve leave for future requirements such as higher studies, medical treatment, relocation, or retirement planning.

Additionally, Earned Leave is **encashable**, making it financially beneficial. Employees may receive monetary compensation for unused Earned Leave during retirement, resignation (subject to organizational rules), or during approved leave encashment schemes announced by the employer. This feature ensures that employees are rewarded for maintaining attendance while still preserving flexibility for future leave requirements.

The availability of Earned Leave encourages employees to plan their vacations responsibly, reduce workplace stress, and maintain long-term productivity.

Casual Leave (CL)

Casual Leave (CL) is provided to employees for handling **short-term personal matters, unforeseen situations, and emergency requirements** that cannot be planned well in advance. Every eligible employee is entitled to **12 days of Casual Leave annually**.

Casual Leave is generally utilized for circumstances such as:

- Personal appointments
- Family emergencies
- Urgent household responsibilities
- Religious or social functions
- Short personal travel
- Unexpected situations requiring immediate attention

Unlike Earned Leave, Casual Leave is generally intended for short durations, often ranging from one to three days at a time. It is usually not carried forward to the next calendar year and lapses if not utilized within the prescribed period.

The provision of Casual Leave ensures that employees can attend to urgent personal responsibilities without suffering salary deductions or workplace stress.

Restricted Holidays (RH)

The organization recognizes the cultural and religious diversity of its workforce by offering **Restricted Holidays (RH)**. Every employee is eligible for **two optional holidays every year**, which may be selected from the officially published Restricted Holiday calendar.

Unlike mandatory national holidays observed by all employees, Restricted Holidays provide flexibility by allowing individuals to choose holidays based on their:

- Religious beliefs
- Regional festivals
- Cultural celebrations
- Personal preferences

Examples may include regional New Year celebrations, local festivals, religious observances, or community-specific holidays that are not recognized as compulsory holidays.

This flexible approach promotes inclusiveness and ensures that employees from different cultural backgrounds receive equal opportunities to celebrate important occasions.

Half-Pay Leave (HPL)

Half-Pay Leave (HPL) is another important component of the leave policy, primarily intended for medical situations or extended personal requirements. Employees become eligible for **20 days of Half-Pay Leave per year**, generally after completing **three years of continuous service**.

As the name suggests, employees receive **50% of their regular salary** during this leave period unless organizational rules permit conversion to full-pay leave under specific circumstances.

Half-Pay Leave is commonly utilized for:

- Medical treatment
- Recovery from illness
- Long-term health conditions
- Family care responsibilities
- Extended personal emergencies

The availability of HPL ensures financial support during prolonged absences while balancing organizational resource planning.

2. Special and Extended Leaves

In addition to regular leave provisions, the organization provides several special categories of leave that address family responsibilities, child care, education, and personal development.

These leave categories demonstrate the employer's commitment toward employee welfare beyond routine attendance management.

Maternity Leave

Female employees are entitled to **180 days of fully paid Maternity Leave**, allowing them sufficient time to prepare for childbirth, recover after delivery, and care for their newborn child.

The leave is granted in accordance with applicable government rules and organizational policies.

The objectives of maternity leave include:

- Protecting maternal health
- Supporting newborn care
- Reducing workplace stress during pregnancy
- Promoting healthy recovery after childbirth
- Encouraging work-life balance

The paid nature of this leave ensures that employees can focus entirely on their health and family responsibilities without financial concerns.

Organizations often provide additional support such as flexible joining schedules, nursing facilities, medical assistance, or work-from-home arrangements after maternity leave wherever operationally feasible.

Paternity Leave

Recognizing the important role of fathers in early child care, eligible male employees are granted **up to 15 days of paid Paternity Leave**.

Paternity Leave enables fathers to:

- Support their spouse during childbirth
- Participate in newborn care
- Assist with family responsibilities
- Strengthen family bonding during the initial days after delivery

This leave reflects the organization's commitment toward shared parenting responsibilities and gender-inclusive workplace policies.

Child Care Leave (CCL)

One of the most employee-friendly provisions is **Child Care Leave (CCL)**.

Eligible female employees may avail **up to 730 days of Child Care Leave** during their entire service period.

This leave can be utilized for various child-related responsibilities, including:

- Child illness
- School examinations
- Educational activities
- Emotional support
- Child development needs
- Special care requirements

Unlike maternity leave, Child Care Leave extends throughout the employee's service and allows mothers to balance career responsibilities with parenting obligations.

The availability of such long-duration leave significantly enhances employee satisfaction, retention, and work-life balance.

Study Leave

The organization strongly encourages continuous learning and professional development.

Employees who have completed **at least five years of continuous service** become eligible for **Study Leave of up to two years**, subject to approval and fulfillment of organizational requirements.

Study Leave may be granted for:

- Higher education
- Professional certifications
- Technical specialization
- Research programs
- Management education
- Industry-relevant academic courses

Approval generally depends upon:

- Relevance of the course
- Organizational requirements
- Employee performance
- Service obligations

- Departmental staffing considerations

The objective of Study Leave is to improve employee competencies while simultaneously enhancing organizational capabilities through a more skilled workforce.

Employees returning from Study Leave often contribute advanced knowledge, innovative practices, and improved technical expertise.

3. Offshore and Field Worker Leave Pattern

Employees working in offshore oil and gas installations face significantly different working conditions compared to office-based personnel.

Due to continuous operations, remote locations, and physically demanding environments, the organization follows a specialized duty cycle designed to ensure employee safety, adequate rest, and operational efficiency.

14 Days On – 14 Days Off Duty Cycle

Offshore employees generally follow a **14-day "On" and 14-day "Off" rotational schedule**.

Under this system:

- Employees remain stationed offshore continuously for **14 working days**.
- They work in rotational shifts throughout this period.
- After completion of the offshore assignment, employees receive **14 consecutive days of duty off**.
- The duty-off period serves as compensatory rest before the next deployment.

This rotational schedule is internationally recognized within offshore industries because it helps employees recover physically and mentally after extended work assignments in challenging environments.

The duty-off period is **separate from standard leave entitlements**, meaning employees continue to retain their annual Earned Leave, Casual Leave, and other eligible leave categories.

Compensatory Offs (C-Off)

Operational requirements occasionally demand employees to work beyond their scheduled hours.

To compensate for such additional work, eligible employees are granted **Compensatory Offs (C-Off)** or **Duty Offs**.

Compensatory Offs may be awarded in situations such as:

- Working beyond normal duty hours
- Emergency maintenance activities
- Equipment breakdowns
- Project deadlines
- Workforce shortages
- Extended offshore stay due to bad weather
- Flight or helicopter unavailability
- Operational emergencies
- Disaster response
- Critical production requirements

Instead of immediate overtime payment in certain cases, employees receive additional leave that can be utilized later, subject to departmental approval.

This system ensures fairness while recognizing employee commitment during demanding operational situations.

4. Benefits of the Leave Policy

The organization's comprehensive leave framework offers numerous advantages to both employees and the employer.

Employee Benefits

- Promotes work-life balance.
- Reduces workplace stress and burnout.
- Supports physical and mental well-being.
- Encourages planned vacations and adequate rest.
- Provides financial security during leave periods.
- Supports employees during family emergencies.
- Facilitates parenting responsibilities.

- Encourages higher education and professional development.
- Improves overall employee satisfaction and morale.

Organizational Benefits

A structured leave policy also contributes significantly to organizational success by:

- Increasing employee productivity.
- Improving workforce motivation.
- Reducing absenteeism through planned leave management.
- Enhancing employee retention.
- Attracting skilled professionals.
- Promoting a positive organizational culture.
- Supporting diversity, equity, and inclusion.
- Ensuring compliance with statutory labor regulations.
- Maintaining operational continuity through planned workforce scheduling.